Experiment 7

Comparative Study of Popular No-Code / Low-Code Application Development Platforms

1. Aim

To compare selected no-code and low-code platforms based on ease of use, customization, integrations, deployment, and suitability.

2. Objectives

- Explain the difference between no-code and low-code development.
- Identify comparison criteria for business application platforms.
- Compare representative platforms such as Zoho Creator, Microsoft Power Apps, Google AppSheet, and Bubble.
- Recommend a platform for a sample business requirement.

3. Requirements

Internet access and access to public product documentation or trial accounts where available.

4. Theory

No-code platforms let users create applications mainly through visual interfaces, forms, workflows, and configuration. Low-code platforms use visual development but allow scripts or custom code for advanced behavior. Platforms vary in data connectors, workflow capabilities, mobile support, user permissions, reporting, extensibility, and pricing. The most suitable platform is not necessarily the one with the largest feature list; it is the one that fits the organization's existing tools, users, security needs, and budget.

5. Procedure

1. Select at least three platforms and review their official feature documentation.
2. Define a common sample task, such as a leave-request or inventory-tracking application.
3. Compare form design, data storage, automation, reports, integrations, access control, and mobile support.
4. Record whether each feature is built in, requires configuration, needs code, or depends on a paid plan.
5. Build a small proof of concept on one platform if a trial is available.
6. Score the platforms against the requirements and document the reason for the final choice.

6. Case Study and Analysis

A small training institute wants an application to register students, track attendance, and send approval requests for event expenses. Zoho Creator may be attractive when the institute wants forms, reports, workflows, and Deluge customization in one environment. Microsoft Power Apps may be a strong candidate when the institute already uses Microsoft 365 and needs integration with its business data. Google AppSheet may suit teams that organize data in spreadsheets and want to build data-driven mobile applications quickly. Bubble is often considered for more customizable web applications, particularly when visual control over user-facing experiences is important. These are starting points rather than universal rankings: exact functionality, connectors, user licensing, and deployment limits depend on current plans. The institute should test a realistic workflow, confirm permissions, and estimate total cost before committing. A short pilot with representative users is more reliable than choosing solely from marketing descriptions.

7. Result / Discussion

The comparison framework identified practical criteria for selecting a platform and showed that platform suitability depends on the organization’s workflow and ecosystem.

8. Conclusion

A structured proof of concept helps avoid choosing a platform based only on popularity. Security, integrations, user experience, maintainability, and total cost should be evaluated together.

9. Precautions / Best Practices

- Use fictional or non-sensitive test data during practice.
- Verify settings and results before using the application or configuration in a real environment.
- Record observations clearly and follow the platform's current documentation, security, and access-control guidance.